SEMPLICE ITALIAN KITCHEN | BUDGET-FRIENDLY ITALIAN

Spaghetti alla Carrettiera: 15-Minute Sicilian Garlic, Herb & Crispy Pangrattato Pasta

PREP: 5 mins | COOK: 10 mins | TOTAL: 15 mins | SERVINGS: 4 servings ($1.15/serving) | CALORIES: 465 kcal

INGREDIENTS

* 400g (14 oz) Bronze-die Spaghetti
* 75g (3/4 cup) Coarse Sourdough Breadcrumbs (Pangrattato) (from day-old crusty bread)
* 60ml (1/4 cup) Extra-Virgin Olive Oil (1.5 tbsp for breadcrumbs + 2.5 tbsp for sauce)
* 4 cloves Fresh Garlic (finely minced or crushed in a mortar)
* 1 tsp Crushed Red Chili Flakes (Peperoncino) (adjust to taste)
* 1/2 cup (25g) Fresh Flat-Leaf Parsley (finely chopped)
* 60g (2/3 cup) Pecorino Siciliano or Pecorino Romano (finely grated)
* 1/2 tsp Dried Sicilian Oregano & Sea Salt

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Toast the Golden Sicilian Pangrattato (4 mins)

While your pasta water heats to a boil, warm 1.5 tablespoons of olive oil in a wide skillet over medium heat. Add the coarse breadcrumbs, a pinch of salt, and 1/2 teaspoon of dried oregano. Stir constantly for 3-4 minutes until deeply golden and fragrant like toasted nuts. Transfer immediately to a cool bowl so they don’t burn, and wipe out the skillet.

Step 2: Boil the Spaghetti Al Dente (8 mins)

Salt the boiling water and cook the spaghetti for 2 minutes less than the package directions.

Step 3: Bloom the Garlic, Chili & Parsley Stems (2 mins)

In the same wide skillet over medium-low heat, warm the remaining 2.5 tablespoons of extra-virgin olive oil with the minced garlic, red chili flakes, and a tablespoon of chopped parsley for 90 seconds until fragrant and pale golden-immediately ladle in 1/2 cup of starchy pasta water to stop the garlic from browning.

Step 4: Emulsify the Spaghetti with Pecorino (2 mins)

Transfer the spaghetti directly into the skillet over high heat and toss vigorously for 90 seconds until the starchy water and olive oil form a creamy glaze. Remove from the burner, add the remaining fresh parsley, grated Pecorino, and half of the toasted breadcrumbs, tossing to coat.

Step 5: Crown with Crunchy Breadcrumbs & Serve (1 mins)

Twirl into warm bowls and pile the remaining half of the crunchy golden pangrattato right on top so every forkful has both creamy emulsion and crisp crunch.

NONNA’S CHEF TIPS:

- Transferring the toasted breadcrumbs out of the hot skillet immediately at Step 1 prevents carryover heat from scorching them.
- Adding a splash of pasta water to the garlic oil as soon as the garlic turns blonde locks in sweet garlic aroma and prevents bitter burnt garlic.